

Yingjie Lei

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Education

Johns Hopkins University <i>M.S.E. in Computer Science (Incoming)</i>	Starting Aug 2026
South China Normal University – Aberdeen Institute of Data Science & AI <i>B.Eng. & B.Sc. (Hons) in Artificial Intelligence</i>	Sep 2022 – Jun 2026
◦ Dual-degree program in Artificial Intelligence ◦ CN Degree: B.Eng. in Artificial Intelligence, South China Normal University (Project 211) ◦ UK Degree: B.Sc. (Hons) in Artificial Intelligence, University of Aberdeen; graduated with First Class Honours ◦ GPA: 90.9/100 (CN), 20.23/22 (UK); Rank: 5/88 (Top 5.7%) ◦ Core Courses: Machine Learning, Data Mining and Visualization, Robot Technology, Languages and Computability, Discrete Mathematics, Probability and Mathematical Statistics	

Research Interests

Computer vision, generative modeling, and world models for embodied planning and robot learning.

Publications & Preprints

PrefBench: Evaluating Zero-Shot LLM Agents in Hidden-Preference Personalized Pricing Negotiations ↗	May 2026
Yingjie Lei <i>arXiv preprint, arXiv:2605.22855, 2026.</i>	
Draft-and-Target Sampling for Video Generation Policy ↗	Under Review
Qikang Zhang, Yingjie Lei , Wei Liu, Daochang Liu <i>Under review, 2026.</i>	
Test Time Training for 4D Medical Image Interpolation ↗	Apr. 2025
Qikang Zhang*, Yingjie Lei *, Zihao Zheng, Ziyang Chen, Zhonghao Xie <i>IJCNN 2025, Oral Presentation.</i>	

Research Experience

Undergraduate Thesis: Personalized Pricing of Customized Car Features <i>Supervised by Dr. Binod Bhattacharj; Thesis grade: 92/100; Outstanding Thesis (Top ~3%)</i>	SCNU / Aberdeen Jan. 2026 – Apr. 2026
◦ Formulated hidden-preference personalized pricing as a POMDP with latent buyer traits, multi-round negotiation, and profit-oriented sequential decision making. ◦ Built a reproducible simulator benchmark with public-data-grounded persona generation, explicit observable/hidden trait separation, fixed evaluation splits, and shared episode-level metrics. ◦ Implemented heuristic and learning-based seller agents, including PPO and DreamerV3, and ran ablations on reward design, semantic features, and inference-time adaptation. ◦ Refined the thesis into PrefBench ↗, a preprint for evaluating LLM agents under hidden buyer preferences.	
Draft-and-Target Sampling for Video Generation Policy <i>Second Author, manuscript under review</i>	SCNU Apr. 2025 – Sep. 2025
◦ Proposed Draft-and-Target Sampling (DTS), a training-free acceleration framework for diffusion-based video generation that uses dual denoising trajectories within a single model. ◦ Introduced Token Chunking and Progressive Acceptance to reduce redundant resampling while preserving output fidelity.	

- Achieved up to **2.1× speed-up** on *Meta-World*, *iThor*, *Libero* with minimal accuracy drop, and surpassed baselines in accuracy on *iThor*.
- Studied the method in embodied-style video-policy settings, emphasizing inference efficiency for downstream decision-making rather than only generic video generation quality.
- **Personal Contributions:** Implemented and refined the core pipeline, ran ablations and benchmarks on *Meta-World* and *iThor*, organized results, created task visualizations, and contributed to manuscript writing and revision.

Test Time Training for 4D Medical Image Interpolation

SCNU

Co-first Author, paper published in the *Proceedings of IJCNN 2025 (Oral)*

Sep. 2024 – Feb. 2025

- Proposed a **Test Time Training (TTT)** framework for 4D medical image interpolation to handle distribution shift without requiring target-domain labels.
- Designed a shared-encoder adaptation mechanism using self-supervised tasks, including *rotation prediction* and *3D-MAE reconstruction*, during inference.
- Achieved state-of-the-art results on **Cardiac MRI** and **4D-Lung CT** (**33.7dB** and **34.0dB PSNR**) with improved robustness under distribution shift.
- Framed the method as a reusable adaptation template for downstream medical vision tasks such as segmentation and registration under shifting test distributions.
- **Personal Contributions:** Implemented the core 3D-MAE module, ran experiments and metric evaluation, created visualizations, improved code clarity, and contributed to manuscript writing and revision.

Selected Course Projects

LLM-Based Intelligent Schedule Assistant (Score: 99/100, UK Grading)

Feb 2025 – Jun 2025

- Led a 6-person team to build an LLM-powered scheduling assistant; designed the system architecture, implemented the Python backend, and integrated the DeepSeek and Google Maps APIs, resulting in the highest course score of 99/100.

Self-Supervised Learning with SimCLR and MAE (Score: 90/100, UK Grading)

Feb 2025 – Apr 2025

- Implemented and compared **SimCLR** and **MAE** with a ViT backbone on Imagenette; **MAE** achieved **89.6%** Top-1 accuracy with stronger F1 and better efficiency, resulting in a project score of 90/100.

Honors & Awards

SCNU Comprehensive Scholarship (3rd Prize)

Apr 2026

Merit-based award recognizing strong academic record and overall performance

SCNU Outstanding Student Scholarship

Mar 2025

Awarded to top students with excellent academic performance (Top 8% in cohort)

SCNU-UoA Joint Institute Scholarship (3rd Prize)

Oct 2024

Granted for outstanding GPA performance, ranked 5th out of 86 students

SCNU Comprehensive Scholarship (3rd Prize)

Mar 2024

Merit-based award recognizing strong academic record and overall performance

Skills & Qualifications

- **Tests:** IELTS Academic 7.5 (L 8.5, R 8.5, W 6.5, S 7.0); GRE 319 (Q 170, V 149, AW 3.5)
- **Programming:** Python (Proficient, Research/Project Experience), Java (Academic Coursework).
- **ML/DL:** PyTorch (Solid Research Experience), HuggingFace, Diffusion Models, Transformers, CNNs, Reinforcement Learning, Test Time Training, Classic ML Algorithms (e.g., Regression, Clustering).
- **Data Science/Tools:** Jupyter Notebook, NumPy, pandas, Scikit-learn, Matplotlib, Seaborn, Data Preprocessing, Exploratory Data Analysis (EDA), Clustering, Data Visualization.
- **Productivity/Documentation:** LaTeX (Academic Writing/Reports), Git (Version Control), Zotero (Research Data and Citation Management), Microsoft 365.
- **Languages:** Mandarin (Native), Cantonese (Native), English (Fluent)